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Coherent Corp | North America

PhotonLink: Lighting a Path to an NPO/CPO Future

With PhotonLink launch, Coherent is providing a roadmap to customers who have lofty goals to build NPO solutions, but don't have all the know-how in-house. While customers likely to pick and choose within the product set, having the know-how/production experience should help with share.

Key Takeaways

- Coherent's PhotonLink solution set helps show how to assemble an NPO solution, addressing all 17 categories of technology that potentially come together.
- Working through the challenges for the customer can give those without meaningful optical knowledge in house a path towards earlier NPO adoption.
- Given desire for customers to have an open approach, full system sale may be a challenge, but does give COHR an avenue towards wallet share gains.
- 2030 SAM rises to \$90B+ from \$70B+, with PhotonLink at \$30B+ vs. ~\$15B CPO prior; NPO/chip-to-chip likely drive the step-up; NPO LTA secured.

We attended Coherent's PhotonLink launch on Monday, September 21st at ECOC in Malaga, Spain.

There is more to optics than just the laser – PhotonLink expands COHR’s role from component supplier toward integrated optics platform provider. Launched during ECOC, PhotonLink brings Coherent’s capabilities across laser generation, signal shaping, fiber guidance and detection into a platform that can be sold as a complete optical solution or as selected building blocks. Management is looking to solve an integration challenge that was a recurring theme at ECOC, where hyperscalers increasingly want open CPO and NPO architectures but may lack the internal expertise to assemble lasers, silicon photonics, FAUs, fiber, micro-optics and packaging across multiple suppliers. PhotonLink allows customers to outsource more of that integration while retaining flexibility over which elements they source from COHR. Coherent’s example spans a complete ELS, ELS-to-chip and chip-to-faceplate optical assemblies, with content reaching up to \$15K per 100T of I/O at 200G per lane. ECOC discussions similarly pointed to a more open integrated optics ecosystem emerging, particularly around NPO, even as the eventual architecture remains fluid.

Customer engagement is expanding, talking to new NPO LTA. Coherent disclosed more than 10 CPO engagements, more than 10 NPO engagements and more than 5 chip-to-chip engagements, with scale-out CPO revenue beginning in Q4CY26, scale-up CPO in H2CY27 and NPO in H2CY27. While NVDA partnership remains the

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Coherent Corp (COHR.N, COHR US)				
Telecom & Networking Equipment United States of America				
Stock Rating	Equal-weight			
Industry View	In-Line			
Price target	\$375.00			
Shr price, close (Sep 23, 2026)	\$300.60			
Mkt cap, curr (mm)	\$64,838			
52-Week Range	\$440.00-102.14			
Fiscal Year Ending	06/26	06/27e	06/28e	06/29e
EPS (\$)**	5.61	9.24	13.29	16.74
Prior EPS (\$)**	-	-	-	-
EPS (\$)§	5.46	9.38	14.01	18.66
P/E	85.4	36.3	24.3	19.0
ModelWare EPS (\$)	4.62	8.29	12.35	15.82
Div yld (%)	-	-	-	-

Unless otherwise noted, all metrics are based on Morgan Stanley ModelWare framework
** = Based on consensus methodology
§ = Consensus data is provided by Refinitiv Estimates
e = Morgan Stanley Research estimates

QUARTERLY EPS (\$)					
Quarter	2026	2027e Prior	2027e Current	2028e Prior	2028e Current
Q1	1.16	-	1.96	-	2.94
Q2	1.29	-	2.18	-	3.22
Q3	1.41	-	2.42	-	3.52
Q4	1.74	-	2.67	-	3.58

e = Morgan Stanley Research estimates

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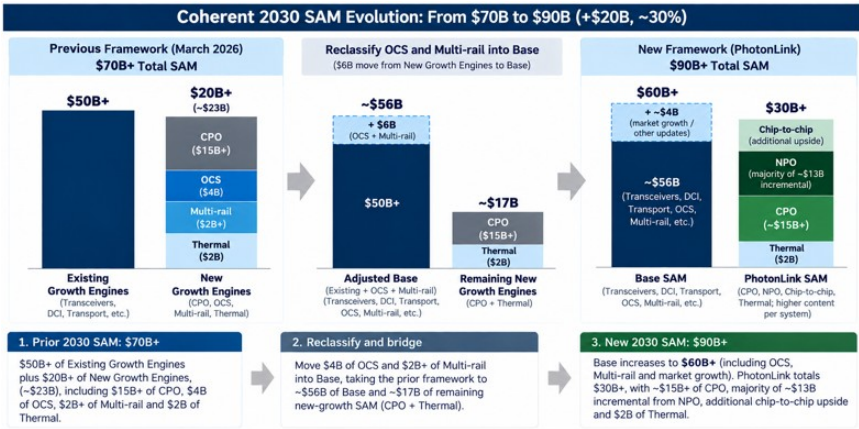
clearest path to revenue, we were encouraged by the NPO LTA announcement. Volumes unknown, but growing number of commitments encouraging.

Scalability and an open ecosystem remain key to broader NPO / CPO adoption.

Moving optics directly onto the switch package can reduce electrical reach and improve power and bandwidth density, but it also places sensitive photonics alongside increasingly power-dense switching silicon, creating challenges around thermal management, package yield, serviceability and the failure domain of the overall system. ECOC discussions continued to emphasize that first-generation architectures are unlikely to represent the final form factor and that meaningful scaling and implementation challenges remain. NPO offers a potentially cleaner compromise by moving the optical engine close to the ASIC while retaining a socketed and serviceable module. COHR's existing manufacturing scale should help as these architectures move toward volume production: management cites more than 300M InP lasers, 700M GaAs VCSELs, 300M optical modules, 80M fiber assemblies and 1B InP/GaAs photodetectors shipped into datacenter applications, providing an established manufacturing base across much of the PhotonLink stack. Capacity is also moving ahead of expected adoption, with available VCSEL-array capacity targeted above 1B units annually and InP production expanding materially through CY27. Nearer term, COHR is already shipping millions of CW lasers per month, expects volume shipments of its ultra-high-power CW laser in Q4-CY26, and targets production readiness for its NPO/CPO VCSEL-array solutions across 1H27 and 2H27. As we wrote in our [first-take note yesterday](#), Open CPX should also broaden the supplier ecosystem and alleviate some of the vendor lock-in concerns heard around CPO at OFC, supporting greater confidence in initial NPO deployments over the next several years.

2030 SAM steps up to \$90B+, a \$20B (~30%) increase versus the prior \$70B+ framework. New framing consists of \$60B+ of Base SAM plus \$30B+ of PhotonLink SAM, versus the prior \$50B+ of Existing Growth Engines and \$20B+ of New Growth Engines. Prior New Growth Engines included roughly \$15B+ of CPO, \$4B of OCS, \$2B+ of Multi-rail and \$2B of thermal, implying roughly \$23B of individually sized opportunities despite the \$20B+ headline. Reclassifying OCS and Multi-rail into Base moves the like-for-like starting point to roughly \$56B of Base SAM and \$17B of remaining new-growth SAM, consisting primarily of CPO plus thermal. Against that adjusted base, the new framework implies roughly \$4B of incremental Base SAM and \$13B of incremental PhotonLink/new-growth SAM. We think most of the latter reflects fuller inclusion of NPO, which COHR has discussed but never separately sized, with chip-to-chip also contributing as optics moves closer to the compute package. Higher content per system should provide another source of expansion as PhotonLink broadens COHR's role from discrete components toward complete optical solutions spanning silicon photonics, fiber, optics and assemblies, with management citing up to \$15K of content per 100T I/O chip.

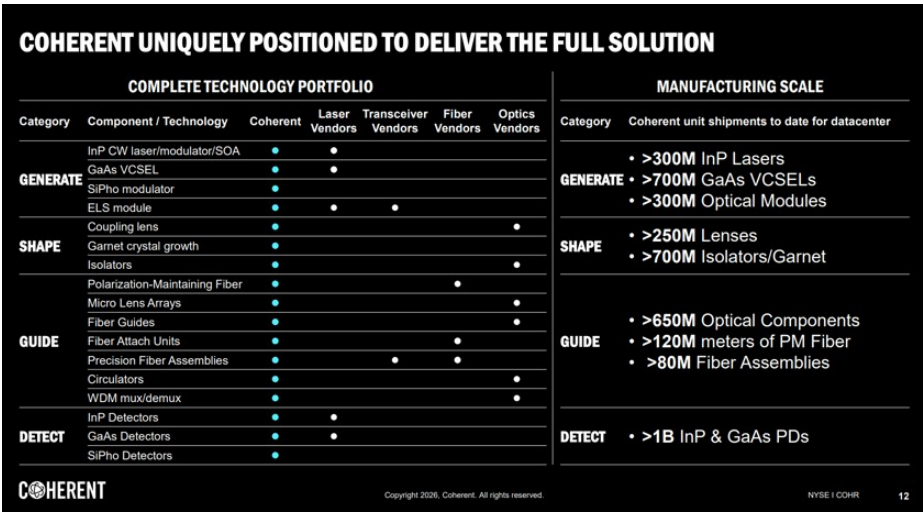
Exhibit 1: On a like-for-like basis, COHR’s Base SAM rises ~\$4B, while ~\$13B of incremental new-growth SAM appears largely tied to fuller NPO inclusion, with chip-to-chip adding further upside



Source: Company data, Morgan Stanley Research

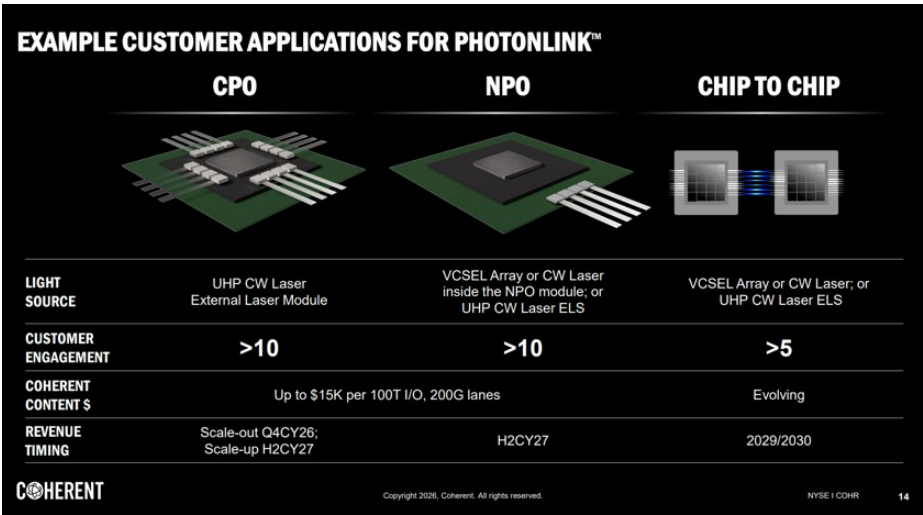
Exhibits

Exhibit 2: COHR's vertical integration across the optical stack, backed by proven high-volume manufacturing, should help de-risk CPO/NPO scaling



Source: Company data

Exhibit 3: CPO ramps first despite similar >10 customer engagements in NPO, highlighting the key question of what is gating NPO deployment until 2H27



Source: Company data

Exhibit 4: NPO traction is building, with >10 active engagements, an anchor customer and LTA secured, and production ramp targeted for 2H27

EXAMPLE 2A: NPO SOLUTION WITH CW LASER

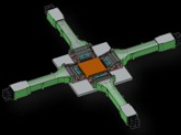
Silicon Photonics NPO/InP CW Laser



6.4Tb/s Silicon Photonics
Socketed NPO
15 Gb/s/mm²



FAU integrating PMLA, Fiber
Guide, PMF



Precision Fiber Assembly



ELS integrating internal InP CW
laser, lens, isolator, TEC,
fiber assembly

- NPO architecture offers enhanced serviceability and architectural flexibility
- End-to-end solution for silicon photonics NPO
 - ELS with InP UHP CW laser; or
 - Integrated HP CW laser
- >10 active customer engagements
- Coherent content up to \$15K per 100T I/O
- Anchor customer and LTA secured
- Production ramp 2HCY27



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NYSE: COHR 41

Source: Company data

Valuation Methodology and Risks

Coherent Corp (COHR.N)

~28x Base FY28e EPS (~\$13.3). Multiple trades at premium to historical trading range given AI exposure, trading more in-line with AI comps.

Risks to Upside

- Pricing increases help gross margins
- 1.6T AI opportunity ramps faster than expected, benefitting margins
- Recovery in non-datacomm portions of business
- CPO / NPO ramps quicker than expected

Risks to Downside

- CPO / NPO delayed
- AI build out pause
- Competitive pressures in datacomm

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	Count	% of Total	Count	% of Total IBC	% of Rating Category	Count	% of Total Other MISC
Overweight/Buy	1555	42%	450	48%	29%	767	44%
Equal-weight/Hold	1577	43%	395	42%	25%	770	44%
Not-Rated/Hold	3	0%	1	0%	33%	1	0%
Underweight/Sell	559	15%	93	10%	17%	216	12%
Total	3,694		939			1754	

Data include common stock and ADRs currently assigned ratings. Investment Banking Clients are companies from whom Morgan Stanley received investment banking compensation in the last 12 months. Due to rounding off of decimals, the percentages provided in the "% of total" column may not add up to exactly 100 percent.

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Coherent Corp (COHR.N) - As of 09/23/26 GMT in USD
Industry : Telecom & Networking Equipment



Stock Rating History: 9/1/21 : E/I; 12/15/21 : 0/I; 4/12/22 : 0/C; 8/12/22 : E/C; 12/13/22 : 0/C; 12/13/23 : E/I

Price Target History: 5/6/21 : 80; 12/15/21 : 82; 6/13/22 : 75; 8/12/22 : 59; 10/11/22 : 43; 12/13/22 : 45; 2/8/23 : 48;
5/10/23 : 40; 8/3/23 : 55; 8/16/23 : 39; 12/13/23 : 45; 2/6/24 : 58; 8/15/24 : 72; 10/17/24 : 100; 12/17/24 : 120; 1/31/25 : 110;
2/5/25 : 115; 4/8/25 : 47; 5/7/25 : 70; 5/22/25 : 74; 5/28/25 : 83; 7/8/25 : 92; 8/4/25 : 97; 8/13/25 : 89; 10/10/25 : 120;
11/5/25 : 150; 12/17/25 : 180; 1/30/26 : 190; 2/4/26 : 200; 2/23/26 : 250; 4/19/26 : 290; 5/6/26 : 330; 8/13/26 : 375

Source: Morgan Stanley Research Date Format : MM/DD/YY Price Target --- No Price Target Assigned (NA)
Stock Price (Not Covered by Current Analyst) — Stock Price (Covered by Current Analyst) —
Stock and Industry Ratings (abbreviations below) appear as ♦ Stock Rating/Industry View
Stock Ratings: Overweight (O) Equal-weight (E) Underweight (U) Not-Rated (NR) No Rating Available (NA)
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INDUSTRY COVERAGE: Telecom & Networking Equipment

COMPANY (TICKER)	RATING (AS OF)	PRICE* (09/23/2026)
Meta A Marshall		
Arista Networks (ANET.N)	O (10/31/2023)	\$203.47
Axon Enterprise Inc (AXON.O)	O (12/03/2024)	\$450.61
Ciena Corporation (CIEN.N)	E (10/10/2025)	\$355.91
Cisco Systems Inc (CSCO.O)	O (04/08/2024)	\$106.43
Coherent Corp (COHR.N)	E (12/13/2023)	\$300.60
Corning Inc (GLW.N)	E (06/13/2024)	\$154.48
F5 Inc (FFIV.O)	E (04/12/2022)	\$455.99
Keysight Technologies Inc (KEYS.N)	O (07/13/2026)	\$353.36
Lumentum Holdings Inc (LITE.O)	E (05/12/2021)	\$937.00
Motorola Solutions Inc (MSI.N)	O (12/17/2025)	\$460.44
Zebra Technologies Corporation (ZBRA.O)	E (12/02/2024)	\$371.02

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* Historical prices are not split adjusted.